

Acme Corp — FY27 Innovation Portfolio & Stage-Gate Review

The full pipeline from idea to in-market, with gate decisions and the discontinue slate

Document type Innovation portfolio & stage-gate review

Period FY27 planning

Owner VP Innovation; R&D; Insights

Prepared July 2026

Pipeline size	25 concepts across 6 stage-gates
Live now (Q2 FY26)	ProteinPeak Cinnamon Crunch + Cocoa Almond
Biggest near-term bet	Crunchwell Pack Refresh — \$28M yr1, launch 2026-08-15
Gate passed	ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond — 64% top-2-box, cannibalization clears
Discontinue slate (Q3)	RootDay Coconut, HoneyNest Granola Crunch + Cookie Dough

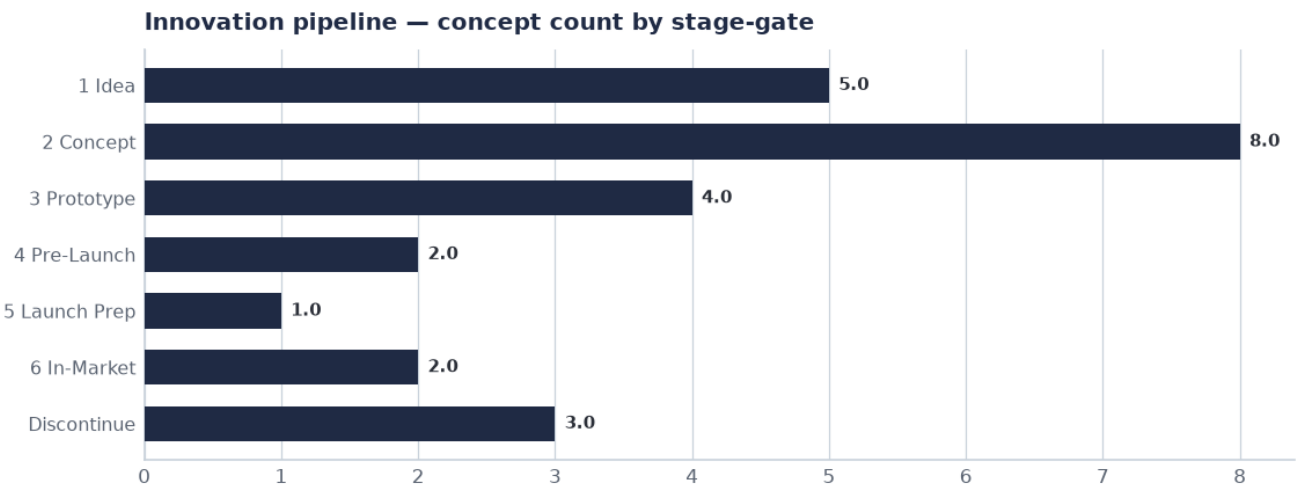
Executive summary

The innovation pipeline holds 25 concepts spanning six stage-gates, with a combined projected year-1 revenue of \$135M across the fundable concepts. Two ProteinPeak SKUs are live (Cinnamon Crunch, Cocoa Almond, launched 2026-04-20); the Crunchwell Pack Refresh is the single biggest near-term bet at \$28M year-1 revenue and a 2026-08-15 launch; and the ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond concept has cleared its stage-gate on a 64% top-two-box score with cannibalization inside the SteerCo threshold. Against those advances, the portfolio is also pruning: three low-return SKUs are confirmed for discontinuation in Q3. The governance question for FY27 is whether the funnel is appropriately weighted toward the two pockets that are actually growing — protein and single-serve — versus legacy line extensions.

- **Live (Stage-6):** ProteinPeak Cinnamon Crunch (\$14M yr1, conf 0.74) and Cocoa Almond (\$10M, 0.68) — the Q2 growth engine, launched 2026-04-20.
- **Biggest bet (Stage-5):** Crunchwell Pack Refresh, Hero SKUs — \$28M yr1, conf 0.82, launch 2026-08-15, tied to the Louisiana recovery (Leg 3).
- **Gate passed:** ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond cleared its action standard — 64% top-two-box (>55% gate) and 8pp substitutional cannibalization (<12pp SteerCo gate).
- **Pre-launch LTOs:** HoneyNest Birthday Cake (\$2.4M, Q4) and MorningOats Cup Pumpkin Spice (\$1.8M, Q3).
Discontinue Q3: RootDay Coconut Blend, HoneyNest Granola Crunch, HoneyNest Cookie Dough.

1 · The pipeline funnel

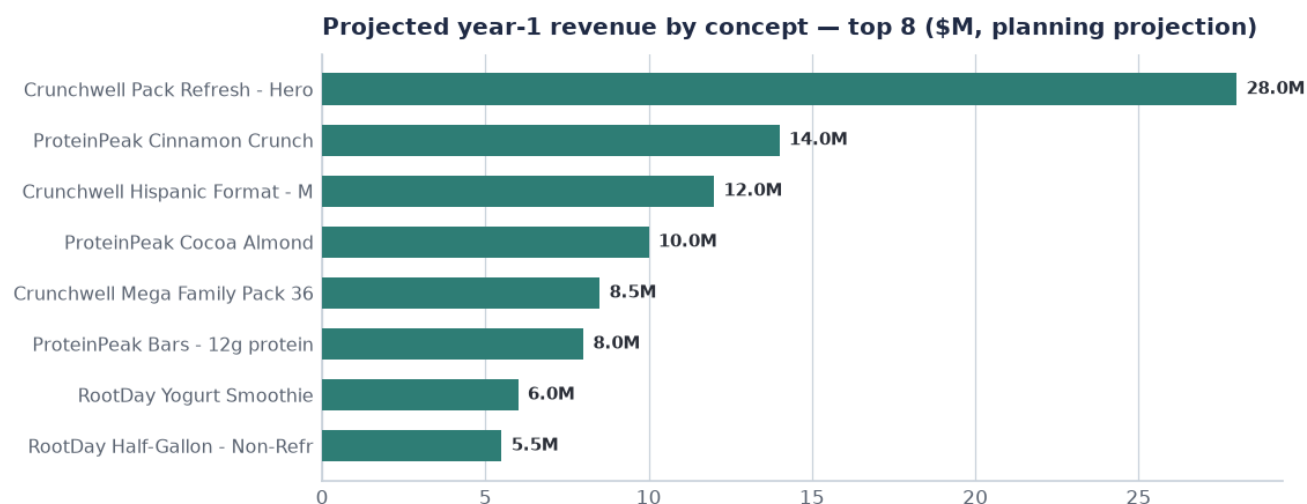
TOTAL CONCEPTS	LIVE IN-MARKET	LAUNCH-READY	DISCONTINUING
25	2	3	3
6 stage-gates	ProteinPeak Q2	S4 + S5	Q3 FY26



A wide idea/concept base narrowing to two live SKUs — a healthy funnel shape, discontinues aside.

The funnel is broad at the front (13 concepts across Stage-1 Idea and Stage-2 Concept) and appropriately narrow at the back (two live SKUs, one in launch prep, two pre-launch). Three concepts sit in the final

discontinue gate. The shape is right; the composition is the question — the early stages lean toward Crunchwell and RootDay line extensions where the confidence scores are lowest (0.22–0.46), while the highest-confidence bets are the protein and pack-refresh moves already deep in the pipe.



The Crunchwell Pack Refresh (\$28M) dwarfs the field; the two live ProteinPeak SKUs follow.

2 · Stage-by-stage detail

2.1 · Stage-6 · In-market (live now)

Concept	Brand	Yr1 rev (proj.)	Conf.	Launch
ProteinPeak Cinnamon Crunch	ProteinPeak	\$14.0M	0.74	2026-04-20
ProteinPeak Cocoa Almond	ProteinPeak	\$10.0M	0.68	2026-04-20

2.2 · Stage-5 · Launch prep

Concept	Brand	Yr1 rev (proj.)	Conf.	Launch
Crunchwell Pack Refresh - Hero SKUs	Crunchwell	\$28.0M	0.82	2026-08-15

2.3 · Stage-4 · Pre-launch

Concept	Brand	Yr1 rev (proj.)	Conf.	Launch
HoneyNest Birthday Cake LTO	HoneyNest	\$2.4M	0.68	2026-Q4
MorningOats Cup Pumpkin Spice LTO	MorningOats	\$1.8M	0.72	2026-Q3

Source: seed_csv('innovation_pipeline.csv'). Year-1 revenue is a planning projection, not booked revenue.

The \$28M Crunchwell Pack Refresh is the biggest single bet

At \$28M projected year-1 revenue and confidence 0.82, the Crunchwell Pack Refresh (Hero SKUs, launch 2026-08-15) dwarfs every other near-term concept and doubles as Leg 3 of the Louisiana recovery, carrying \$1.4M of LA-targeted media. Its scale means it is also the biggest execution risk in the portfolio — a base-defence move, not a growth-pocket move, so its job is to hold Family Sweet share, not add to it.

3 · Gate decision — ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond

The ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond concept (ProteinPeak Q3 candidate) cleared its stage-gate. On a monadic test of n=1,000, it scored 64% top-two-box purchase intent against Acme's 55% cereal-innovation action standard — +6pp versus the ProteinPeak launch-SKU pretest and +11pp versus the five-year innovation benchmark. Purchase intent is strongest exactly where the brand needs it: 71% top-two-box in the protein-curious cohort (3.06 mean intent) and 66% in lapsed-cereal, versus 52% in current-Crunchwell buyers.

3.1 · Concept-test scorecard

Metric	Result	Read
Top-two-box purchase intent	64%	≥55% action standard → clears
vs launch-SKU pretest	+6pp	improving on the prior launch
vs 5-yr innovation benchmark	+11pp	top-decile concept
Protein-curious cohort TTB	71%	the target cohort
Cannibalization (substitutional, vs launch SKUs)	8pp	<12pp SteerCo gate → clears

Metric	Result	Read
Cannibalization (substitutional, vs Crunchwell)	2pp	negligible

Source: seed_concept_test_chocolate_almond (n=1000, field 2026-06-22 → 2026-07-11).

Gate PASSED — but time-critical

The concept clears both gates: 64% top-two-box (>55%) and 8pp substitutional cannibalization against the ProteinPeak launch SKUs (<12pp SteerCo threshold), with a further +14pp chocolate-breakfast preference among protein-curious households (U&A; Apr 2026). With Larksfield's chocolate variant trademarked (Report 32), this concept should be fast-tracked, not parked.

4 · Discontinue slate & governance

4.1 · Confirmed discontinuations — Q3 FY2026

SKU	Brand	Timing	Status
RootDay Coconut Blend	RootDay	2026-Q3	Discontinue-Plan
HoneyNest Granola Crunch	HoneyNest	2026-Q3	Confirmed-Discontinue
HoneyNest Cookie Dough	HoneyNest	2026-Q3	Confirmed-Discontinue

Source: innovation_pipeline.csv, Stage-Final Discontinue.

Three SKUs are confirmed or planned for discontinuation in Q3 FY26: RootDay Coconut Blend (niche, sub-scale distribution), HoneyNest Granola Crunch and HoneyNest Cookie Dough (both in the structurally-declining Kids Sweet pocket, per Report 30). Pruning these frees shelf, supply-chain complexity and marketing focus for the protein and pack-refresh bets. A fourth SKU — RootDay Single-Serve Carton — sits on-hold at Stage-3.

4.2 · Stage-gate governance

The stage-gate discipline is working where it is applied: the Chocolate Almond concept was held to a quantified 55% action standard and a 12pp cannibalization ceiling, and passed on evidence rather than advocacy. The FY27 governance priorities are (1) apply the same quantified gates to the eight Stage-2 concepts, several of which carry sub-0.45 confidence and no clear whitespace thesis; (2) rebalance the early funnel toward the growing pockets; and (3) protect the two funded winners — the ProteinPeak line and the Crunchwell Pack Refresh — from resource dilution by lower-confidence line extensions.

Portfolio risk

The early funnel over-indexes on legacy line extensions (Crunchwell, RootDay) at low confidence, while the category's growth is in protein and single-serve (Report 30). Without a deliberate rebalance, the pipeline will keep generating low-return concepts in shrinking pockets and starve the pockets that are actually winning.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Fast-track ProteinPeak Chocolate Almond to launch to pre-empt Larksfield's Q4 chocolate (Report 32).	VP Innovation / Sage Park	Now

#	Action	Owner	When
2	Protect the Crunchwell Pack Refresh launch (2026-08-15) as the biggest bet and Louisiana recovery Leg 3.	Cory Whitman	Q3 FY26
3	Execute the Q3 discontinue slate; reallocate freed shelf/supply to protein and single-serve.	R&D; / Supply	Q3 FY26
4	Apply quantified stage-gates to the Stage-2 concepts; kill or advance on evidence (cross-ref LRP, Report 15).	VP Innovation	FY27 planning